

Materials

Everything around us is made of materials. Different materials have different qualities. Some, such as metals, are hard and strong. Others, such as plastics, can be easily moulded, or shaped. Engineers, scientists, and designers create and use materials in lots of different ways.

Ceramics

Ceramics are hard but break easily. They can cope with really high temperatures – space shuttles have ceramic tiles to protect them from extreme heat.

People have been making ceramic pots and vases for thousands of years.



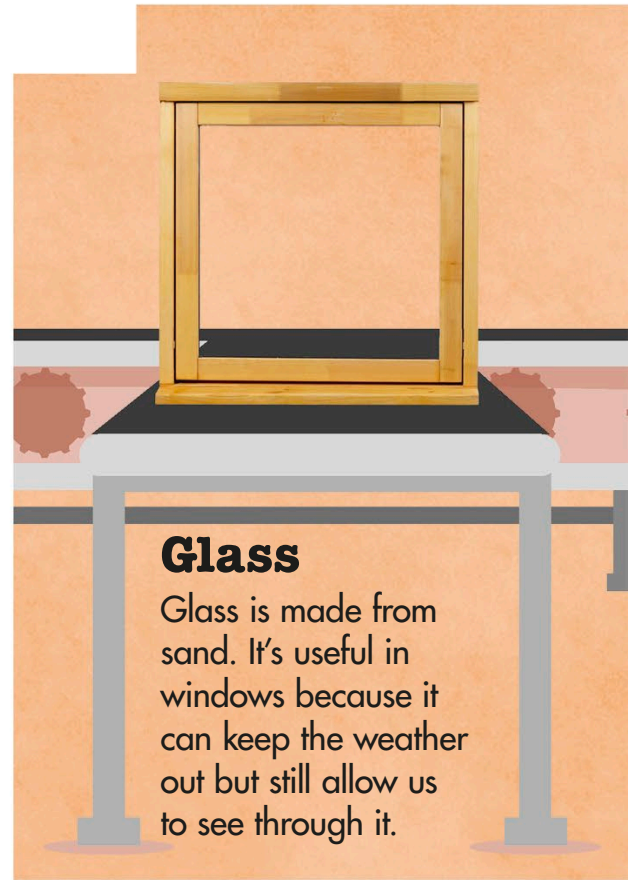
Plastic

Plastic is a human-made material that has many different qualities. It is light, waterproof, and can be hard or soft.



Glass

Glass is made from sand. It's useful in windows because it can keep the weather out but still allow us to see through it.



At very high temperatures, metals become soft and can be reshaped.

Metal

Metals are usually strong and easy to shape when heated. They are conductors, which means electricity and heat can travel through them. Some metals are magnetic.

